AGENTS IN PRODUCTION · NYC · OCT 12

Who owns an agent's state?

The process that created it is gone. The work isn't done. Something has to remember where it was.

Alex Yedi

SINCE SPRING, 2026

Four layers now claim it

Model vendor
NOT ON STAGE

OpenAI Agents API keeps the session on OpenAI's side · **beta, Sep 10**

Workflow engine
RUNS ON AGENTCORE

Temporal valuation **$5B (Feb) → $12.55B (Sep)**

Runtime
ON STAGE · AWS

AgentCore sessions **8 h standard → 14 days on EC2**

Database
ON STAGE · SURREALDB

SurrealDB 3.0 ships as an agent-memory release · **Feb**

Sources: OpenAI 2026 · Runtimewire 2026 · aws-news 2026 · SurrealDB 2026

TWO DIFFERENT THINGS

Memory ≠ checkpoint

Checkpoint

ONE RUN

- Where the agent is
- What it's waiting on
- Restored after a crash

Memory

ACROSS RUNS

- What it learned
- Kept and corrected over time
- Outlives any process

MongoDB ships both, side by side.

SurrealDB docs: Agent Memory is "not an agent runtime."

Sources: MongoDB 2026 · SurrealDB docs 2026

THE QUESTION NOBODY IS ASSIGNED

It wakes up days later.

What is it still allowed to do?

Alex Yedi